CONSULT FOR AFRICA

The Care Coordinator Safety Card

The CFA MBA, Term 1: Medicine and the Hospital

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Summary

- Applies: from today, on every Mezo call, WhatsApp and form.
- Your job: get the patient to the right doctor, at the right place, at a confirmed fee. You do not assess, diagnose or advise.
- The one rule above all others: if anything in the request could be an emergency, direct the caller to emergency care first and book second.
- Read it, keep it beside you, and confirm on your task by Friday 6 November.

1. Emergency first: the red flags

If the caller describes any of these, stop the booking and say the script in section 2.

Who	Red flag
Anyone	Chest pain or tightness, especially with sweating, breathlessness or pain spreading to the arm or jaw
Anyone	Severe difficulty breathing, or lips turning blue
Anyone	Face drooping, arm weakness, slurred speech, sudden confusion: signs of a stroke
Anyone	Collapse, unconsciousness, a fit that will not stop or a first fit
Anyone	Heavy bleeding that will not stop, or vomiting or coughing blood
Anyone	Severe sudden headache, "the worst of my life"
Anyone	Severe abdominal pain, especially with a hard swollen belly or vomiting
Anyone	Swelling of the face, lips or tongue, or difficulty breathing after a drug, food or sting
Anyone	A serious injury: road crash, fall from height, deep wound, burn
Anyone	Talk of suicide or self-harm, or a plan to act on it
Pregnancy	Bleeding, severe headache or blurred vision, fits, leaking fluid, severe pain, or the baby moving much less
After birth	Heavy bleeding, fever, breathlessness
Babies under 3 months	Any fever
Children	Floppy or very drowsy, not feeding or drinking, fast or difficult breathing, a fit, a rash that does not fade when pressed
Sickle cell	Severe pain crisis, chest pain, breathlessness, fever, sudden weakness
Diabetes	Confusion, drowsiness, or very high or very low sugar readings

- In doubt: treat it as an emergency. A wasted trip to emergency care costs an evening. A missed emergency can cost a life.

2. What to say

> "From what you are telling me, this needs a doctor now, not an appointment. Please go to the nearest hospital emergency department straight away, or call 112. If you cannot get there, tell me where you are and I will help you find the nearest one."

- Stay on the line until the caller has a plan: where they are going and how.
- Log it on the request, with the time and what the caller was told.
- Follow up the next day: a call to ask how the patient is. If they still need a specialist, book it then.

3. What you never do

- Diagnose: never say what you think it is, including "it sounds like malaria" or "it is probably nothing".
- Reassure on symptoms: you have not examined the patient. "The doctor will look at that" is the answer.
- Advise on medicines: never tell a caller to start, stop or change a medicine, or what dose to take. "Please keep taking your medicines as prescribed until you see the doctor, and ask the doctor that question."
- Recommend a doctor on quality: match on specialty, location, availability, fee and payer. Every doctor on the network is MDCN verified.
- Promise an outcome: of a surgery, a fertility treatment or an aesthetic procedure.
- Quote a fee the facility or doctor has not confirmed.

4. Patient information

- Consent: before you share anything with a doctor or facility, tell the caller what you are sending and to whom. Note that they agreed.
- Third parties: a relative calling on someone's behalf, including family abroad, can book and pay. They do not receive results, diagnoses or records unless the patient has agreed. If the patient cannot agree (a child, or someone too unwell), note who is calling and why.
- Channels: results and records go through the platform or to the patient's own verified number or email. Never forward them in a group chat or to a number you have not verified.
- Minimum: record what the doctor needs to see the patient. Do not collect what is not needed.
- AI tools: never paste patient information into ChatGPT, Claude or any other AI tool.
- Law: patient health information is sensitive personal data under the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023. Mishandling it is a legal breach as well as a breach of trust.

5. Every request, every time

Step	What you record
1	Red flags screened, and the answer
2	The complaint in the patient's own words, then in clinical terms, and how long
3	Age, sex, location, and whether pregnant where relevant
4	Known conditions, current medicines, allergies
5	Payer: cash, HMO (plan and enrollee number), or a family member paying
6	The specialist, facility, date and fee confirmed with the caller before payment

Step	What you record
7	Consent to share with the doctor
8	Follow-up: a call after the visit to check the patient was seen and knows the next step

6. When something goes wrong

- A complaint, a patient harmed or a visit that went badly: log it on the request and tell Debo the same day. Do not argue, apologise for the clinical care, or promise a refund on the call. "I am sorry this happened. I have recorded it and someone senior will come back to you by [day]."